Deskwatch

Transparency & Security Report

What Deskwatch does, what it connects to, what data it touches and how it protects you

Version: 2.10.1 Date: November 3, 2026 Windows 10 and 11

> This document is a **self-assessment**: it was prepared by the project itself by reviewing the application's entire source code, not by an independent security firm. It is published so anyone can know exactly what the program does. If you find something that doesn't add up, let us know and we'll look into it.

At a glance

✓ **No telemetry or analytics**

Deskwatch does not collect usage data, does not send crash reports and has no servers of its own to send anything to.

✓ **Internal server is local only**

The internal server only answers your own computer and is protected by a secret key that changes on every launch. A website open in your browser cannot control it. Your conversations do go to Anthropic, as in Claude Code (section 2).

✓ **It doesn't store your credentials**

It neither reads nor stores your Claude credentials: it only asks Claude Code whether you are signed in and shows your email and plan. The GitHub token is never stored or logged, and is only handed to github.com.

✓ **No administrator rights**

It installs for your user only and installs no services. In the registry it only writes the uninstall entry and, if you turn it on, start with Windows. It also reads PATH to find newly installed programs.

! **Installer without a digital signature**

For now the installer is not signed with a publisher certificate, which is why Windows may show "Unknown publisher". Details in section 8.

1. What Deskwatch is

Deskwatch is a Windows desktop app that shows your **Claude Code** sessions (Anthropic's coding assistant) as characters in a 3D office. From it you can start new sessions, chat with each agent, approve or deny the permissions they ask for, keep an eye on your plan usage and save your projects to GitHub.

Deskwatch is not an AI model and does not replace Claude Code: it uses Anthropic's official tool (the `Claude Agent SDK`, bundled with the installer) with **your own** Claude account. Conversations go from your computer to Anthropic exactly as when you use Claude Code in a terminal.

2. Internet connections

These are the destinations Deskwatch's code connects to. In addition, Claude Code agents can connect wherever you allow them (web tools, MCP servers, git, npm), and editor extensions wherever their authors decide.

DESTINATION	PURPOSE	WHEN
Anthropic (via Claude Code)	Conversations with the agents and checking your plan usage. If you turn on Remote Control, the conversation is also published on claude.ai.	While you use agents. With the window visible, also every 5 to 15 minutes for plan usage (with the window hidden, only if the usage guard is on).
github.com (downloads)	Checking for new Deskwatch versions.	At launch and every 4 hours. It only downloads if you accept.
GitHub (`github.com`, `api.github.com`) and other Git remotes	Saving, pushing and pulling changes to your projects; creating repositories; installing skills you choose. If your project uses another Git server, it connects to it (without sending it your GitHub token). The Requirements screen queries `api.github.com` to see which account you are signed in with.	When you ask and, in Requirements, while that screen is open.
YouTube (`youtube.com`, `youtube-nocookie.com`, `i.ytimg.com`)	The office TVs and radios, if you play a video. Searching sends the text you type to YouTube. The embedded player also loads Google resources.	Only if you use that feature.
Open VSX (open-vsx.org)	The code editor's extension catalog: searching, installing and updating extensions.	Only when you use the editor's extensions panel. It does not check for updates on its own.

Deskwatch opens no internet connection to Discord: the presence talks to the Discord app on your computer, and that app publishes it on your profile (section 5).

3. What it reads on your computer

- Claude Code conversations (`%USERPROFILE%\.claude\projects`), to show history, resume conversations and calculate usage.
- Claude Code configuration (`%USERPROFILE%\.claude\settings.json`), its skills and plugins.
- The folders of the projects you add, to show their Git status. Deskwatch watches those folders for changes and, when there are any, asks Git on your computer to keep the indicator up to date; nothing is uploaded or sent. It does not watch your user folder or whole drives. On first launch it adds as projects the folders where you've used Claude Code in the last 90 days (you can remove them any time).
- **On by default** (can be turned off in Settings), PC music: the title, artist and cover of what's playing in Windows (Spotify, the browser…), through a PowerShell script bundled with the app and run with `ExecutionPolicy Bypass`. Only while the window is visible (or if you share music on Discord). It never leaves your computer unless you choose to share it on Discord.

4. What it writes on your computer

LOCATION	CONTENTS
`%USERPROFILE%\.claude\despacho\`	Deskwatch data: projects, notes, decoration, settings, daily usage, attachments you send to terminal sessions (not deleted automatically) and the skills recycle bin. Also `server.json`, holding the port and key of the current local server session, and the hook scripts.
`%APPDATA%\Deskwatch\`	Window settings (system tray, Discord, start with Windows) and built-in browser data: the office's cache and local storage, and the editor's cookies, local database, open tabs and the folders you trust.
`%USERPROFILE%\.claude\settings.json`	Only if you enable it: the hooks from section 5, the reply language and the skills you turn on or off. A full backup is saved before any change (`settings.json.bak-deskwatch`): if your configuration contains keys, they will be in it too, and it stays after uninstalling.
Your projects	Only when you use GitHub from Deskwatch: a basic `.gitignore` (if there is none) and the commits you choose to save.
Skills and permissions	The skills you install (`%USERPROFILE%\.claude\skills` or the project's `.claude\skills`) and the permissions you approve with "always" (the project's `.claude\settings.local.json`).
Temporary folder	Working copies while installing skills, deleted when finished.

5. Optional integrations

Terminal and VS Code sessions (hooks)

If you enable them, Deskwatch adds *hooks* to Claude Code's global configuration. That way it also sees the sessions you open outside the app: each event hands Deskwatch its full content (messages, commands and

tool data, folder and conversation path) **only within your computer**, never over the internet.

Hooks do more than observe: from Deskwatch they can approve or deny permissions, block a message, stop an agent or send it text, for example with the usage guard. Permission and end-of-turn hooks can wait for your answer for up to an hour.

If Deskwatch is closed, the hooks do nothing beyond starting and ending a small `node` process on each event. You can remove them with one click in Settings → Integrations.

Code editor

Since version 2.10.0, Deskwatch includes a full code editor: **Code-OSS**, the open-source code behind VS Code (MIT license), built by the project for Windows. It opens in its own window and runs as a server inside your computer: it only listens on `127.0.0.1`, with its own secret key that changes on every launch, and the window cannot navigate to other websites.

It includes a **terminal** that runs commands on your computer, like any terminal; it, the extensions and their processes inherit your environment variables, including any keys in them. It comes without telemetry and without GitHub Copilot or other third-party AI assistants, and its internal views (such as the Markdown preview) are served from your computer. Code-OSS's code still contains addresses of Microsoft and GitHub services for features that are not present here. In one test of this version (opening a folder, trusting it, source control, terminal, extensions panel and one idle minute) the only external connections were to **Open VSX**; that test does not cover every possible use. Extensions are installed from Open VSX and run with your permissions, just like in VS Code: only install the ones you know, because they can connect wherever they want. The editor does not check for extension updates on its own. Its data is stored in `%USERPROFILE%\.claude\despacho\editor` and in `%APPDATA%\Deskwatch\Partitions`.

To keep it light, GitHub Copilot and the GitHub and Microsoft sign-ins, which do not work here, have been removed. The first time you open a folder it asks whether you trust it and remembers your answer. In a folder containing several repositories, it only opens the one for the files you open, and never one from a parent folder.

It is **in Spanish** if your Windows is in Spanish (and in English otherwise). The translation is VS Code's official language pack (MIT license) and ships inside the editor: nothing is downloaded when you use it. It covers the vast majority of the interface; a few very recent VS Code texts are not translated yet and appear in English.

Discord presence

On by default, it publishes on your Discord profile, visible to others, the number of agents and how many are working or waiting, the status ("working" or "in the office"), the launch time and a button to deskwatch.es. The **project name** and the **music** are shared only if you turn them on in Settings (since version 2.9.21). File names and conversation contents are never shared.

Start with Windows

Off by default. Closing the window keeps Deskwatch in the system tray (this can be changed in Settings). While hidden, background work that isn't needed stops: PC music, reading past conversations, plan checks and Git checks. It catches up when you return. Running sessions and their alerts, Discord presence if you use it, and update checks stay active.

6. Credentials

- **Claude:** Deskwatch neither reads nor stores your Claude credentials. Login is handled by Claude Code; Deskwatch only asks it whether you're signed in and shows your email and plan.
- **GitHub:** to push changes it uses the session you already have in the official `gh` tool. The token is passed to Git in memory only and is only handed to github.com (a submodule on another server does not get it): it is never written to disk, to your repository or to any log. Addresses containing a username and password are rejected, and error messages are scrubbed of credentials before being shown.

7. Security measures

AREA	PROTECTION
Local server	Listens only on `127.0.0.1` (your own computer). Requires a random secret key, different on every launch, on every request. Rejects requests with any other host name (prevents DNS rebinding). Does not allow requests from other websites (no CORS).
App window	Isolated (`contextIsolation` , `sandbox` , no Node access). It cannot navigate away from the office; links open in your browser. Every system function checks the call comes from the office itself.
Agent content	Markdown replies are cleaned with DOMPurify before being shown; all other text is escaped. A Content Security Policy (CSP) prevents running any code other than the app's own.
Built-in browser	Only fullscreen, protected video playback and, for local pages, notifications and clipboard are granted. Microphone, camera, location and all other permissions are denied.
System commands	Git, GitHub CLI, Claude Code and PowerShell run with separate arguments and, except for the sign-in console windows, without a command shell: a file or branch name cannot inject commands. Programs are not looked up in the project folder, so a `git.exe` inside it is not run.
Agent permissions	Each agent uses the permission mode you choose (ask, accept edits, auto…; a new project starts on auto). Unknown values are rejected. The permission dialog is an aid, not a barrier against the agent itself (section 8).
Files	The server only serves the app's own files; paths trying to escape that folder are rejected.
Code editor	Its own server, only on `127.0.0.1` and with its own key, which does not appear on the command line. Deskwatch's button only opens folders of your projects or agents; inside the editor you can open any folder. Its window is isolated (no Node, no access to the office) and never leaves its server. Each internal view is isolated in its own local origin (`*.localhost`).

8. Findings from this review

What was found in the reviews of versions 2.9.21, 2.10.0 and 2.10.1, with its status. Nothing was found in 2.10.1 (copying and pasting notes, desk customization). Those that do not state a version were fixed in 2.9.21.

FINDING	SEVERITY	STATUS
A `git.exe` or `gh.exe` inside a folder added as a project ran instead of the real program. Earlier versions were affected too: updating is advised	High	✓ Fixed in 2.10.0 and checked with the real attack.
The GitHub token could be handed to another server that asked for it during an operation on a GitHub repository (for example, a submodule)	Medium	✓ Fixed in 2.10.0: it is only handed to github.com.
An unexpected failure in a background task could close the app	Medium	✓ Fixed in 2.10.0.
An interruption while saving could damage settings and disable the usage guard	Medium	✓ Fixed in 2.10.0: atomic writes.
The editor key, which gives access to a terminal, was on its command line	Medium	✓ Fixed in 2.10.0: it is passed through a file deleted at startup.
The editor's configuration still held addresses for Copilot's voice and chat agent	Medium	✓ Fixed in 2.10.0: removed from its configuration. The rest of Code-OSS's code still contains other addresses (section 5).
Minor details: unlimited simultaneous Git processes, unvalidated project color, unrestricted browser permissions, unchecked link	Low	✓ Fixed in 2.10.0.
A copied folder or zip with a crafted `.git` can run programs when its status is checked, because Git applies each repository's configuration. `git clone` does not bring that configuration	Medium	! Reduced, not eliminated. `core.fsmonitor` no longer runs, but a Git filter does. Disabling filters would break legitimate repositories: only add folders you trust.
An agent can read `server.json` and use that key to approve its own permissions	Medium	! By design. The permission dialog is not a security barrier against an agent acting hostilely. Claude Code's permission mode remains your main control.
The editor, extensions and agents inherit your environment variables, including any keys in them	Medium	! By design, as in a terminal. Avoid keeping secrets in global variables.
The editor is built from a fixed Code-OSS version. It only gets security patches with a new Deskwatch version; its files are not verified at startup and the translation is not downloaded against a fixed hash	Medium	! Pending. The Spanish pack is from an earlier editor version, so some text stays in English.
The `settings.json.bak-deskwatch` backup holds your full configuration, and the uninstaller does not remove the hooks	Medium	! Pending. Follow the steps in section 10.
If Deskwatch closes abruptly, editor processes may stay open	Low	! Pending. They close on restart or from Task Manager.

FINDING	SEVERITY	STATUS
`DESKWATCH_UPDATE_URL` and `DESKWATCH_EDITOR_DIR` change where the app updates from and which editor it uses	Low	! Pending. They require another program that can already set your environment variables.
DOMPurify 3.4.16 library with known vulnerabilities (not exploitable with the way Deskwatch used it)	High	✓ Fixed in 2.9.21: updated to 3.4.17. `npm audit` : 0 vulnerabilities.
No Content Security Policy (CSP)	Medium	✓ Fixed: strict CSP, plus `nosniff` , `no-referrer` and anti-framing protection.
Discord shared the project name and music by default	Medium	✓ Fixed: now opt-in (off by default).
An agent's permission mode was not validated	Medium	✓ Fixed: only Claude Code's modes are accepted.
Removing a skill accepted `.claude\skills` folders anywhere	Medium	✓ Fixed: only global skills or those of your projects.
Checks that could be stricter: conversation id, plugin id, file paths, request size, window navigation	Low	✓ Fixed.
A copy of `settings.json` piled up on every hooks change	Low	✓ Fixed: a single copy. Older ones (`settings.json.bak-despacho-*`) can be deleted by hand.
The hooks notice did not explain they apply to every session	Low	✓ Fixed: the text now explains it.
Installer and updates without code signing	High	! Pending. Updates are checked against a SHA-512 hash, but that hash comes from the same GitHub page. If someone took over the project's account they could publish a fake version. Signing the installer is planned.
Another program already running as your user can read the local server key, or ask the server itself for it, and use its API. The same goes for other Windows users on the same PC who can connect to it	Medium	! Accepted for your user: a malicious program running as you could already read your files or run Claude Code. If you share the PC with other Windows users, keep this in mind.
Third-party skills and plugins are installed from the repositories you choose	Medium	! By design. Deskwatch shows a preview before installing; only install skills from sources you trust, just like in Claude Code.

9. Recommendations for you

- Only download Deskwatch from **deskwatch.es** or **github.com/davidrfyt/deskwatch/releases**.

- Keep the app up to date: it tells you itself when a new version is available.
- Choose each project's permission mode carefully. "Don't ask" mode lets the agent act without asking for permission.
- Only install skills, plugins and editor extensions from sources you trust.
- Only add folders you trust as projects, especially if they come from a zip or from someone else.

10. Uninstalling completely

- Before uninstalling, if you enabled terminal sessions: Settings → Integrations → **Remove** the hooks. The uninstaller does not remove them: otherwise `settings.json` will keep pointing to a script that will be gone if you delete your data.
- Uninstall Deskwatch from Windows Settings → Apps.
- To delete your data as well: the folders `%USERPROFILE%\.claude\despacho` and `%APPDATA%\Deskwatch`, and the `settings.json.bak-*` copies in `%USERPROFILE%\.claude` (the `despacho` folder includes the editor's data and extensions). Your projects and your Claude Code conversations are left untouched.

11. How this review was done

Deskwatch's own code in version 2.10.1 was fully reviewed (local server, interface, Claude Code integration, Git and GitHub, Electron window, editor, updates and installer), looking for network connections, file access, credential handling, command execution and unfiltered content. The review was done by AI agents (Claude) supervised by the author; it is not an external audit. Dependencies were checked with `npm audit`. Important flaws were reproduced with real tests and the fixes were tested again in operation.

Some low-severity findings were assessed by reading the code only. The PC music pause while the window is hidden was checked in the code only.

The code editor (Code-OSS) is third-party software: it is developed by Microsoft as an open-source project and has not been audited line by line. Its integration into Deskwatch, the changes applied to it (`scripts/editor.mjs`, `scripts/editor-i18n.mjs`, `scripts/editor-sanitize.mjs`, `scripts/after-pack.cjs` and `lib/editor.mjs`) and its behavior were reviewed: it only listens on your computer and requires its key. Its connections were measured in a single test, with the editor open in Chrome (section 5).

Licenses: Deskwatch includes Anthropic's `Claude Agent SDK`, with `claude.exe`, which is not free software and has its own license. The traffic of `claude.exe` itself was not analyzed in this review.

This report will be updated when there are relevant changes.

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